

Q.4. Part A: Determine the Thermal voltage V_T at 25°C

The Formula for thermal voltage is

$$V_T = \frac{kT}{q}$$

Step 1. Convert the temperature to Kelvin

$$T_K = T_C + 273$$

$$T = 25 + 273 = 298\text{K}$$

Step 2: Boltzmann's Constant,

$$k = 1.38 \times 10^{-23} \text{ J/K}$$

Charge of an electron:

$$q = 1.602 \times 10^{-19} \text{ C}$$

$$\text{Step 3: } V_T = \frac{(1.38 \times 10^{-23})(298)}{1.602 \times 10^{-19}}$$

$$V_T = 0.02567 \text{ V}$$

$$V_T \approx 25.7 \text{ mV}$$

Part B.

Step 1: calculate the exponent

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{V_D}{nV_T} &= \frac{0.5}{2 \times 0.02567} \\ &= \frac{0.5}{2 \times 0.02567} \\ &\approx 9.739\end{aligned}$$

Step 2: Substitute into the diode equation.

$$I_D = I_S (e^{\frac{V_D}{nV_T}} - 1)$$

$$\text{Given, } I_S = 40 \times 10^{-10} \text{ A}$$

$$I_D = (40 \times 10^{-9}) (e^{9.739} - 1)$$

$$e^{9.739} \approx 16966.5$$

$$I_D = (40 \times 10^{-9}) (16966.5 - 1)$$

$$= 0.000678 \text{ A} \quad \text{or } I_D = 0.678 \text{ mA}$$